# Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held Electronically on Monday, February 22, 2021 at 7:00 p.m.

***Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:***
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

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|---|---|---|
| Present: | Mayor | S. Collier |
| | Regional Councillors | M. Crawford |
| | | S. Lee |
| | | J. Dies |
| | Councillors | R. Tyler Morin |
| | | A. Khan |
| | | L. Bower |

## 1. Call to Order & Land Acknowledgement

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

## 2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

## 3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the following Minutes of previous Council meetings be adopted:

- Regular Meeting of January 25, 2021; and
- Closed Session Meeting of January 25, 2021

CARRIED

## 4. Question Period

Mayor Collier noted that members of the public were advised they could submit questions regarding the agenda to the Town Clerk up until noon on the day of the meeting. Alexander Harras, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk, noted that no items of correspondence had been received regarding the contents of the meeting agenda. Two requests to make unscheduled delegations were received in relation to agenda item 7.4.2.

## 5. Delegations and Presentations

### 5.1 Presentation: Upgrades at the Duffins Creek Water Pollution Control Plant

John Presta, Director of Environmental Services, Regional Municipality of Durham, delivered a presentation regarding upgrades at the Duffins Creek water pollution control plant. J. Presta discussed recommendations from the Outfall Class Environmental Assessment (EA) and Phosphorus Reduction Action Plan (PRAP) Study, outfall diffuser upgrades, ferric chloride dose points upgrades, polymer addition to primary clarifiers, density current baffles in secondary clarifiers, project schedule and status, and 2020 Plant Performance.

Council Members asked questions regarding nuisance algae, tertiary treatment, funding sources for outfall diffuser upgrades, plant expansion, effluent treatment, the Lake Ontario discharge alternative and frequency of reporting periods. J. Presta responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked J. Presta for his presentation.

### 5.2 **Presentation: Grandview Children's Centre: Capital Build Update**

Lorraine Sunstrum-Mann, CEO, Grandview Children's Centre, provided an update on the status of the new Grandview Children's Centre facility. L. Sunstrum-Mann discussed services and supports available to residents across Durham Region, timelines for the P3 Model, property acquisition for the development, site plan illustration, vertical expansion, and architectural design.

Council Members asked questions regarding satellite offices across the Region and project timelines. L. Sunstrum-Mann responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked L. Sunstrum-Mann for her presentation.

## 6. Correspondence

Members separated correspondence items 6.1, 6.2 and 6.7.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the balance of the report (Items 6.3, 6.4, 6.5, 6.6, 6.8, 6.9, 6.10, 6.11, 6.12, 6.13, 6.14, 6.15, 6.16 and 6.17) dated February 22, 2021 containing Items of Correspondence be received for information.

CARRIED

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That Items 6.1 ("Region of Durham – Upper York Sewage Solution"), 6.2 ("Region of Durham – 2021 Census of Populations"), and 6.7 ("City of Oshawa – COVID-19 Economic Recovery and Provincial Occupancy Restrictions") of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

## 7. Reports

### 7.2 **General Government Committee Report**

#### 7.2.1 **2021 Operating & Capital Budget, February 8, 2021**

Councillor Khan, Budget Chair, provided comments regarding the outcome of the 2021 Operating & Capital Budget and thanked staff for their hard work on the preparation of the 2021 Budget.

Council Members asked questions regarding Ajax Public Library's obligation to repay a portion of grant funds received through the Canada Emergency Wage Subsidy (CEWS), Library operating surplus, library stabilization reserve funds, forecasted impacts to the Library due to reduced reserves, and the Library operating budget. Sarah Vaisler, Chief Librarian and Executive Officer, Matthew Tapscott, Ajax Public Library Board Chair, and Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Council Members.

Council Members asked further questions regarding the 2022 budget gap estimate allocation to the 2021 budget, reserve balance after repayment of the CEWS, and target balance for reserve allocations outlined in the Library Reserve Policy. S. Vaisler and D. Valentim responded to questions from Council Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the General Government Committee 2021 Operating & Capital Budget Meeting Report dated February 8, 2021 be adopted.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: J. Dies

That recommendation #8 of the final budget recommendations contained within the 2021 Operating & Capital Budget Meeting Report of February 8, 2021 be amended to read as follows:

> That $700,000 of the 2020 Library operating surplus be requested to be returned to the Town and be directed to the Stabilization reserve.

Amendment to the Amendment

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the amendment be further amended to read as follows:

That recommendation #8 of the final budget recommendations contained within the 2021 Operating & Capital Budget Meeting Report of February 8, 2021 be amended to read as follows:

> That **$850,000** of the 2020 Library operating surplus be requested to be returned to the Town, **$700,000 of which shall be directed to the Stabilization reserve and $150,000 of which shall be directed to the Stormwater Maintenance Reserve.**

MOTION LOST

Amendment

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: J. Dies

That recommendation #8 of the final budget recommendations contained within the 2021 Operating & Capital Budget Meeting Report of February 8, 2021 be amended to read as follows:

> That $700,000 of the 2020 Library operating surplus be requested to be returned to the Town and be directed to the Stabilization reserve.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the General Government Committee 2021 Operating & Capital Budget Meeting Report dated February 8, 2021 be adopted, as amended.

CARRIED

7.2.2 **General Government Committee, February 16, 2021**

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the General Government Committee Report dated February 16, 2021, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.3 **Summary of Advisory Committee Activities**

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the Summary of Advisory Committee Activities Report dated February 22, 2021, as attached to the meeting agenda be received for information, and that the recommendations contained therein be referred to staff where applicable.

CARRIED

7.4 **Departmental Reports**

7.4.1 **Amendment to the North Harwood Employment Property Agreement of Purchase and Sale with Grandview Children's Centre**

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Council approve a by-law to execute an Amending Agreement of Purchase and Sale with Grandview Children's Centre for the sale of the North Harwood Property.

CARRIED

7.4.2 **Envision Durham - Municipal Comprehensive Review Town of Ajax Position on Requests for Employment Area Conversions – Amended**

Motion to Suspend the Rules of Procedure

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Rules of Procedure be suspended in order to allow unscheduled delegations and presentations regarding Departmental Report 7.4.2.

CARRIED
on 2/3rds

Council recessed at 8:31 p.m.

Council resumed at 8:36 p.m.

**Delegation: Conversion Request #CNR-14**

David Kemper, President & Managing Partner for Belmont Equity, delivered a presentation regarding conversion request #CNR-14 and clarified that the conversion request is for the 1.4 acre undeveloped portion of the site. D. Kemper noted that the owners are committed to maintaining prestige employment and retail uses at grade level of the proposed residential building. D. Kemper provided an overview of the proposed development on the 1.4 acre parcel.

Council Members asked questions regarding projected number of units, underground parking development and parking sustainability, snow removal, traffic flow, job density projections and opportunities for second floor office space. D. Kemper responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked D. Kemper for his delegation.

**Delegation: Conversion Request #CNR-09**

Scott Waterhouse, Planning Manager, Urban Planning and Land Development, GHD Limited, delivered a presentation regarding conversion request #CNR-09. S. Waterhouse provided justifications for the conversion request and asked Council to support the living area designation to permit expanded retail floor area opportunity to attract a grocery store of sufficient scale.

Council Members sought clarification regarding Town of Ajax Official Plan Area Specific Policy 6.18 and if the proponent is requesting that the Policy not be applied. Council Members asked questions regarding permitted uses for living area designation, proposed use for the conversion request, and permitted uses for prestige employment. S. Waterhouse responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked S. Waterhouse for his delegation.

Council Members asked questions regarding time constraints for submission of comments to the Region, projected employment figures, uses permitted for prestige employment and the legal opinion with respect to conversion request #CNR-19. Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services and Sean McCullough, Supervisor, Planning & Policy Research, responded to questions from Council Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

1. That Council receive the staff report entitled "Envision Durham – Municipal Comprehensive Review, Town of Ajax Position on Requests for Employment Area Conversions", for information.

2. That Council endorse staff's position of each respective Employment Area Conversion Request as presented in Attachment 1: Town of Ajax Employment Area Conversion Request Position, as follows:

    a. That conversion requests CNR-03, CNR-21 and CNR-22 be supported to permit mixed-use residential uses as these requests are located within the draft expanded Major Transit Station Area (Ajax GO Station) delineation;

    b. That conversion requests CNR-04 not be supported, and that the Region of Durham lift its deferral on Town of Ajax Official Plan Area Specific Policy 6.18 along Harwood Avenue North to allow for enhanced retail uses within this area;

    c. That conversion requests CNR-09, CNR-31 and CNR-34 not be supported but that Town of Ajax Official Plan Area Specific Policy 6.18 be added to the south side of Bayly Street East between Shoal Point Road and Audley Road South;

    d. That a special policy framework be added to the Regional Official Plan for the lands identified in Recommendations 2b and 2c to permit enhanced minor retail permissions on those employment lands; and,

    e. That conversion requests CNR-14, CNR-28, and CNR-35 not be supported as these parcels are located within strong and emerging employment areas and/or represent some of the largest serviced employment parcels in the Town.

3. That as directed by Council during a Special Council Meeting held on February 11, 2021, staff notify the Region of Durham Planning and Economic Development Department that the Town supports conversion requests CNR-07, CNR-15, CNR-19, and CNR-20, and CNR-33 subject to amendments and conditions outlined in Attachment 2: Excerpt from February 11, 2021 Special Council Meeting Resolution.

4. That a copy of this staff report and attachment be forwarded to the Region of Durham Planning and Economic Development Department.

Amendment

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: S. Lee

1. That recommendation #2 c. be amended by removing reference to CR-09; and

2. That staff be directed to advise the Region of Durham that Ajax Council is in support of expanded floor area to permit a larger sized grocery store with respect to conversion request #CNR-09.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

1. That Council receive the staff report entitled "Envision Durham – Municipal Comprehensive Review, Town of Ajax Position on Requests for Employment Area Conversions", for information.

2. That Council endorse staff's position of each respective Employment Area Conversion Request as presented in Attachment 1: Town of Ajax Employment Area Conversion Request Position, as follows:

a. That conversion requests CNR-03, CNR-21 and CNR-22 be supported to permit mixed-use residential uses as these requests are located within the draft expanded Major Transit Station Area (Ajax GO Station) delineation;

b. That conversion requests CNR-04 not be supported, and that the Region of Durham lift its deferral on Town of Ajax Official Plan Area Specific Policy 6.18 along Harwood Avenue North to allow for enhanced retail uses within this area;

c. That conversion requests CNR-31 and CNR-34 not be supported but that Town of Ajax Official Plan Area Specific Policy 6.18 be added to the south side of Bayly Street East between Shoal Point Road and Audley Road South;

d. That a special policy framework be added to the Regional Official Plan for the lands identified in Recommendations 2b and 2c to permit enhanced minor retail permissions on those employment lands; and,

e. That conversion requests CNR-14, CNR-28, and CNR-35 not be supported as these parcels are located within strong and emerging employment areas and/or represent some of the largest serviced employment parcels in the Town.

3. That as directed by Council during a Special Council Meeting held on February 11, 2021, staff notify the Region of Durham Planning and Economic Development Department that the Town supports conversion requests CNR-07, CNR-15, CNR-19, and CNR-20, and CNR-33 subject to amendments and conditions outlined in Attachment 2: Excerpt from February 11, 2021 Special Council Meeting Resolution.

4. That a copy of this staff report and attachment be forwarded to the Region of Durham Planning and Economic Development Department.

5. That staff be directed to advise the Region of Durham that Ajax Council is in support of expanded floor area to permit a larger sized grocery store with respect to conversion request #CNR-09.

CARRIED

7.4.3 **Anti-Racism and Diversity Training Plan for Council**

Council Members inquired about reversing the priority order of elements of the training. Natasha Sharma, Diversity & Inclusion Coordinator, responded to Council Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: A. Khan

That staff be directed to implement the Council Anti-Racism and Diversity Training Plan as described in this report.

Amendment

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That phases 1 and 2 as proposed in the Anti-Racism Diversity Training Plan for Council be switched in order.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: A. Khan

That staff be directed to implement the Council Anti-Racism and Diversity Training Plan as described in this report, as amended.

CARRIED

7.4.4 **Ajax Shining Star Bursary Program Update**

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the following Ajax Shining Star Bursary Program Update report be received by Council for information.

CARRIED

7.4.5 **Smart Cities Pilot Project and Grant Application**

Council Members asked questions regarding framework for data protection as it pertains to consumer data protection and value for service related to the pilot project. Nicole Cooper, Director of Information & Legislative Services/Clerk, and Kassandra Cruciano, Grants, Partnerships & Strategic Initiatives Coordinator, responded to questions from Council Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: A. Khan

1. That Council direct staff to apply for the Federation of Municipalities' Municipal Asset Management Program (MAMP) for $24,000 to support the implementation of data- collection pilot project partnership with Bell Canada.

2. That Council approve the use of $6,000 from the Capital Contingency Reserve towards the Town's contribution requirement for the MAMP program, contingent upon grant approval.

3. That Council authorize staff to complete the necessary actions to formalize the partnership and the Town and Bell Canada for a one year pilot project, contingent upon grant approval.

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Deputy Mayor Dies assumed the Chair.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: S. Lee

1. That provision 1 be amended by adding the following:

   and that if the Town's grants application is unsuccessful, that $24,000 be allocated from capital contingency reserve to complete the project.

2. That the words 'contingent upon grant approval' be removed from provision 2.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: A. Khan

1. That Council direct staff to apply for the Federation of Municipalities' Municipal Asset Management Program (MAMP) for $24,000 to support the implementation of data- collection pilot project partnership with Bell Canada, and that if the Town's grant application is unsuccessful, that $24,000 be allocated from capital contingency reserve to complete the project.

2. That Council approve the use of $6,000 from the Capital Contingency Reserve towards the Town's contribution requirement for the MAMP program.

3. That Council authorize staff to complete the necessary actions to formalize the partnership and the Town and Bell Canada for a one year pilot project, contingent upon grant approval.

CARRIED

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

7.4.6 **2021 Report on Non-Cash Expenses as Required by Ontario Regulation 284/09**

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the report on Excluded Non-Cash Expenses, as required by Ontario Regulation 284/09, be received for information.

CARRIED

7.4.7. **Ajax Pickering Hospital Foundation Annual Gift**

A. Harras noted that this matter was referred from the January 18, 2021 GGC meeting and the recommendations contained therein have been superseded by the approval of the 2021 Operating & Capital Budget meeting report (item 7.2.1). The report and recommendations were withdrawn.

## 8. Regional Councillors' Report

Mayor Collier provided an update regarding the projected increase to the Region's 2021 budget.

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of February 22, 2021 be received for information.

CARRIED

## 9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

Motion to Suspend the Rules of Procedure

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the rules of procedure be suspended in order to introduce a motion without notice regarding In-store Alcohol Service at Convenience Stores.

CARRIED
on 2/3rds

9.1 **Gas-Fired Electricity**

Regional Councillor Crawford introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Lee

**WHEREAS** the Government of Ontario is planning to increase electricity generation and greenhouse gas pollution from Ontario's gas-fired power plants by more than 300% by 2025 and by more than 400% by 2040, reversing more than a third of the greenhouse gas pollution reductions achieved by phasing out our coal-fired power plants;

**AND WHEREAS** greenhouse gas pollution is causing temperatures in Canada to rise at more than double the rate of the rest of the world, causing impacts to the operations and residents of the Town of Ajax;

**AND WHEREAS** the Town of Ajax is taking measures to mitigate and adapt to the climate impacts caused by increasing greenhouse gas pollution, which includes having climate adaptation and mitigation plans in place;

**AND WHEREAS** the planned increase in electricity-related greenhouse gas pollution will reduce the effectiveness of the Town's greenhouse gas reduction efforts;

**AND WHEREAS** there are feasible, cost-effective alternatives to increasing gas-fired electricity generation without increasing greenhouse gas pollution at costs well below the current price for Ontario's nuclear energy (9.5 cents/kWh), including:

- energy efficiency investments;

- low-cost, distributed, renewable energy; providing employment in Ontario communities and restoring our leadership in this industry;
- the purchase of low-cost power offered by the Province of Quebec from its existing hydroelectric generating stations; and
- using Quebec's system of reservoirs as a battery to back-up made-in-Ontario renewable power, eliminating the need to use gas-fired power plants for this purpose;

**NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:**

1. The Town of Ajax requests the Government of Ontario to place an interim cap of 2.5 megatonnes per year on the greenhouse gas pollution from Ontario's gas-fired power plants and develop and implement a plan to phase-out all gas-fired electricity generation by 2030 to help Ontario and the Town of Ajax meet their climate targets; and

2. This resolution be sent to the Premier of Ontario, the Hon. Greg Rickford, Minister of Energy, Northern Development and Mines, the Hon. Jeff Yurek, Minister of the Environment, Conservation and Parks, MPP Rod Phillips, the Association of Municipalities of Ontario, Chair John Henry, Durham Region Climate Roundtable Committee and Durham Region Works Committee.

CARRIED

9.2 **Durham-Scarborough BRT in Pickering Village**

Regional Councillor Crawford and Councillor Tyler Morin introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

**WHEREAS** Metrolinx is undertaking the Durham-Scarborough Bus Rapid Transit (BRT) project that will connect the southern Durham Region municipalities to Scarborough along Highway 2/Kingston Road, including a 5-lane design across Highway 2/Kingston Road through historic Pickering Village;

**AND WHEREAS** The Town of Ajax is proud of our storied history and commitment to preserving our heritage and historic areas like Pickering Village, and to telling the stories that shaped the importance of these areas;

**AND WHEREAS** Ajax Council recognizes Metrolinx for their ongoing commitment to partnership, demonstrated by providing updates to Council and working with the Town to expand the reach and availability of public information sessions, by extending consultation deadlines, and by holding a joint virtual public meeting with Ajax Council and staff;

**NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:**

1. Council request that Metrolinx and the Region of Durham continue to work closely with the southern Durham Region municipalities as the Durham-Scarborough BRT project progresses through the Transit Project Assessment Process;

2. As the detailed design progresses for the proposed Pickering Village section, Metrolinx continues to consult with Town staff and local councillors on acquisitions and widening plans ensure that the design maintains the integrity of the area;

3. Metrolinx be encouraged to reflect the historical significance and place making opportunities of Pickering Village through;
   a. The protection, conservation and restoration of historical properties impacted by the BRT construction;
   b. The design of key project features such as the bus shelters, gateway features and the expansion of the Duffins Creek bridge, so that they reflect the charm and historical character of the Pickering Village area;
   c. The enhancement of existing and development of new public amenities in Pickering Village, in conjunction with the Town's Recreation Master Plan; and

4. This motion be distributed to the Metrolinx BRT project team and the Region of Durham.

CARRIED

9.3 **Conservation Authorities Working Group**

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Regional Councillor Lee assumed the Chair.

Mayor Collier and Regional Councillor Dies introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: J. Dies

**WHEREAS** Significant, substantive legislative changes to conservation authorities' (CA) mandates, board responsibilities and enforcement authority were hastily pushed through the Province's fall budget, Bill 229 (Schedule 6), which received Royal Assent on December 8, 2020 in spite of widespread outcry from environmental experts, municipalities and municipal groups, NGOs and individuals;

**AND WHEREAS** on January 11, 2021 Minister Yurek sent an email to heads of Council across the province to inform them of the composition of a Conservation Authorities Working Group to examine and consult on the regulations that follow legislative changes made through Schedule 6, including: details about which programs and services CAs will deliver and how they may be funded, and how CAs will regulate development (with a lens of public safety), the requirement for CAs to establish community advisory boards, and further details about CA operation and management of lands owned by the authority;

**AND WHEREAS** both the Toronto and Region Conservation Authority (TRCA) and Central Lake Ontario Conservation Authority (CLOCA), as well as the agriculture sector and Association of Municipalities of Ontario (AMO) are represented as part of the working group; however, an additional list of advisors to the working group was also announced, which includes representatives from the development industry (Remington Group, Mattamy Homes and EQ Homes);

**AND WHEREAS** the working group does not consist of representatives from non-governmental agencies who have been very vocal about Schedule 6, including the implications on the mandate and future of CAs;

**AND WHEREAS** CAs should be able to have a fulsome discussion about regulatory issues, including appropriate limitations to development without the interference or lobbying potential of the development industry;

**THEREFORE BE IT NOW RESOLVED THAT:**

1. Ajax Council convey their concern to the Minister of the Environment, Conservation and Parks, requesting that the Province remove the influence of the development industry from the working group, instead having them provide their input as part of the public consultation process like other stakeholders and the general public; and

2. Ajax Council requests that the Minister of the Environment, Conservation and Parks consider adding environmental protection-focused non-governmental agencies onto the working group; and

3. This motion be distributed to the Hon. Jeff Yurek, Minister of the Environment, Conservation and Parks, MPP Rod Phillips, Region of Durham, Chair of the Working Group Hassaan Basit, CEO of Conservation Halton, Conservation Ontario, Toronto and Region Conservation Authority, Central Lake Ontario Conservation Authority, Association of Municipalities of Ontario, and Ontario's Big City Mayors.

CARRIED

9.4 **In-store Alcohol Service at Convenience Stores**

Regional Councillor Lee vacated the Chair. Deputy Mayor Dies assumed the Chair.

Mayor Collier and Councillor Khan introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: A. Khan

**WHEREAS** Ajax Council recognizes the ongoing hardships faced by restaurants, pubs and other foodservice businesses as a result of mandated closures and patron limits due to Covid-19;

**AND WHEREAS** the Town has been working hard to implement and advocate for business supports (such as providing restaurants the ability to access wine, beer and spirits at wholesale or discounted pricing, permitting flexibility, online support and more) to ensure more local businesses survive the pandemic;

**AND WHEREAS** convenience stores have not been mandated to close during the pandemic and have not endured undue hardship like other industries;

**AND WHEREAS** 7-Eleven Canada has applied to introduce in-store alcohol service at 61 stores throughout Ontario (including Ajax) to leverage their open status as a competitive advantage;

**AND WHEREAS** the Alcohol and Gaming Commission of Ontario (AGCO) is ultimately responsible for granting all liquor licensing requests;

**AND WHEREAS** approval of 7-Eleven's request would also mean exposing an already vulnerable and hard-hit restaurant/bar industry to further competition;

**AND WHEREAS** Ontario's Big City Mayors caucus passed a motion on Friday, February 19 opposed to the 7-Eleven Canada request to serve alcohol;

**THEREFORE BE IT NOW RESOLVED THAT** Ajax Council oppose 7-Eleven Canada's proposal to serve alcohol;

**AND THAT** this motion be distributed to Hon. Peter Bethlenfalvy, Minister of Finance; Hon. Doug Downey, Attorney General; Hon. Steve Clark, Minister of Municipal Affairs and Housing; Hon. Prabmeet Sarkaria, Associate Minister of Small Business and Red Tape Reduction; Rod Phillips, MPP for Ajax; the Region of Durham, and local Durham Region municipalities.

CARRIED

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

## 10. By-laws

Members of Council asked questions regarding By-Law 17-2021, authorizing the stop up and close of a portion of Smales Drive. G. Romanowski responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: S. Lee

That By-law numbers 11-2021 to 17-2021 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

## 11. Notice of Motion

Regional Councillor Dies indicated that she will be bringing forward a motion to the March meeting of Council requesting that the Town reaffirm their position with respect to Greenbelt protection for the headwaters of the Carruthers.

Regional Councillor Lee indicated that he will be bringing forward a motion to the March meeting of Council regarding the Town's Hiring Practices.

Mayor Collier indicated that he will be bringing forward a motion to the March meeting of Council directing staff to investigate and report back to Council on the feasibility of acquiring the lands for the Hunt Street extension.

Mayor Collier indicated that he will be bringing forward a motion to the March meeting of Council regarding a Land Bank Tax.

## 12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming events and activities including a Ward 3 virtual Open House for traffic calming implementation on February 25, 2021, a Ward 2 virtual

Open House for traffic calming implementation on February 24, 2021, and a virtual event for In Conversation with the Ajax Anti-Black Racism Task Force on February 25, 2021.

**13. Confirming By-Law**

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: A. Khan

That By-law number 18-2021 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its meeting held on February 22, 2021 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

**14. Adjournment**

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the February 22, 2021 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (10:04 p.m.)

CARRIED

_____
Mayor

_____
D-Clerk